

CDC CITS Orientation

Quick-start context post-RFQ release (May 6, 2026), with proposal due June 1, 2026

About CDC CITS

RFQ snapshot (released May 6, 2026)

The CITS RFQ has been released. Key facts from the actual solicitation document:

- **Solicitation:** RFQ 75D301-26-Q-78845, "Customer Information Technology Support (CITS)"
- **Issued:** May 6, 2026, by CDC OCOO/OFR/OAS, Atlanta, GA
- **Contracting Officer:** Denedra Hardy (qfa5@cdc.gov, 404-498-3371). Secondary: Sherrie Randall (iom2@cdc.gov)
- **Vehicle:** GSA Alliant 2 GWAC (confirmed; previously an assumption)
- **NAICS:** 541512 - Computer Systems Design Services. **PSC:** DA01 - IT and Telecom Business Application/Application Development Support Services (Labor)
- **Set-aside status:** *Ambiguous in the document.* SF-18 cover-page checkbox indicates set-aside; body language says "competitive solicitation issued as full and open." Most likely competed within the Alliant 2 SB pool. **Submit as a clarification question by May 12.**
- **Contract type:** Hybrid - Firm Fixed Price (transition + Subscription) and Time and Materials (services)
- **Period of performance:** 4 years total. Transition 8/1/2026-8/31/2026; Base 9/1/2026-1/31/2027 (5 months); Option 1 2/1/2027-1/31/2028; Option 2 2/1/2028-1/31/2029; Option 3 2/1/2029-1/31/2030; Option 4 2/1/2030-7/31/2030 (6 months)
- **Contract Access Fee:** 0.75% of total price, paid by Ordering Agency, remitted to GSA by Contractor (Alliant 2 standard)
- **Travel NTE caps (Base period):** \$12K (CEO Task 1.3 non-global) + \$15K (DSO Task 5 non-global) + \$15K (DSO Task 9 non-global) + \$198K (CEO Task 2.1 global) = \$240K cost-reimbursable

Key dates

- **Questions due:** May 12, 2026 by 2:00 PM EDT
- **Proposal due:** June 1, 2026 by 2:00 PM EDT
- **Anticipated award / transition start:** August 1, 2026

Proposal compliance summary

- **Two volumes:** Volume I Technical (35-page limit, 11pt Times New Roman or equivalent, 0.75" margins; Section 508 template excluded from page count) and Volume II Business (no page limit)
- **Evaluation factors** (in order of importance, best-value tradeoff): (1) Technical Approach, (2) Staffing Plan, (3) Management Approach, (4) Similar Experience. Past Performance evaluated pass/fail via CPARS. Technical and Past Performance combined are more important than Price; if technical merit is equal, price becomes the significant factor.
- **Similar Experience:** Three (3) relevant contracts similar in scope, size, and complexity, performed within the last three (3) years. Two customer contacts required per reference.
- **Required deliverables in proposal:** Work Plan with milestone charts; Staffing Matrix with LCATs / hours / certs / clearances; Key Personnel; Quality Control Plan (draft); Transition-In Plan; Transition-Out Plan; GFE accountability approach
- **CRITICAL: We cannot describe AI products in our technical approach, and we cannot use AI products in performance after award** (except AI products explicitly provided, approved, and made available by CDC). Use of unapproved AI products after award is a material breach. *Per the RFQ language, this restricts what we propose as our solution and what we use to deliver post-award. It does not restrict using internal AI tools (e.g., Propel AI) to draft the proposal itself.*

What CITS is

The Customer Information Technology Support (CITS) contract is the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) Office of the Chief Information Officer (OCIO) vehicle for delivering IT customer support services across the enterprise. It covers approximately 28,000 CDC personnel spanning CONUS and OCONUS locations, and it is the primary contract that keeps CDC staff productive day-to-day on IT systems, endpoints, and ServiceNow-based ticketing.

Service model

CITS uses a tiered IT Service Management (ITSM) model aligned to ITIL and PMBOK:

- **Level 1 (Service Desk):** First-contact support for incidents and requests, phone and ticket triage, password resets, routine fulfillment.
- **Level 2 (Deskside):** Onsite and remote technical support for escalated incidents, hardware, peripheral, and workstation issues.
- **Level 3 (Specialists):** Engineering and specialized escalation support for complex application, infrastructure, and platform issues.

ServiceNow is the core ITSM platform underpinning ticketing, workflow, knowledge management, and reporting.

CDC objectives for CITS

- Integrated, consistent customer support across all CDC locations
- ITIL and PMBOK alignment
- Continuous improvement in service quality and user experience
- Reduced total cost of ownership
- Compliance with CDC security posture and federal requirements
- Modernization where it delivers measurable value without disrupting operations

Current bid context

The CITS RFQ was released on May 6, 2026 (see RFQ Snapshot above for solicitation details). With proposal due June 1, 2026, the capture has roughly four weeks to finalize teaming, complete capability crosswalks, build the technical and business volumes, and refine pricing.

Client engagement remains constrained due to protest sensitivity (see below), and the questions period (closing May 12) is now the primary remaining shaping channel. Capture continues to lean on partner coordination, pricing discipline, and a defensible solution narrative built on ServiceNow-native automation rather than vendor-introduced AI.

Past pricing signals

- **~\$114M / 5 years (2019, NTT DATA, CDC IT infrastructure and user support).** Public press release value.
- **~\$111M task order (2025).** Reported by Washington Technology for the general IT support recompetes; initially awarded to DMI, then protested by NTT and ultimately returned to NTT.
- **~\$27M task order (2023, on-site application hosting at CDC Atlanta data centers).** Per FPDS and reporting around the GAO protest.
- **~\$12M task order (March 2025, NTT DATA, CDC IT Services on Alliant 2, \$11.69M).** Per USASpending and OrangeSlices reporting.
- **Pricing pressure on CITS is described as significant.** Competitors are expected to price thin; the Government is expected to evaluate aggressively on cost.
- **Relevant past performance comparator size: \$200M-\$300M.** NIH and other HHS work likely the strongest comparators; account-specific examples may be limited.

Sources: NTT DATA 2019 press release; Washington Technology (March 2025, Nov 2023); USASpending.gov / OrangeSlices AI; GAO decisions B-421708.3 / B-421708.4 and B-419197.2. Specific prior-award values and CITS ceiling numbers should be treated as pending validation.

Expected Competitors

Two named competitors are expected to figure prominently in the CITS competition based on public-domain reporting and recent CDC OCIO award and protest activity.

INCUMBENT

NTT DATA Services Federal Government, LLC

Posture: Long-standing CDC IT customer support incumbent. Headquartered in Herndon, VA. U.S. federal arm of Tokyo-based NTT DATA, a global \$30B+ business and technology services firm with deep federal health experience.

Public-domain facts to know

- **Long tenure at CDC.** Has supported CDC since at least 2004 through the CDC Information Management Services (CIMS) IDIQ vehicle. Per NTT DATA's own materials, supports tens of thousands of CDC stakeholders and devices globally.
- **2019 award of ~\$114M / 5 years.** Five-year contract to manage critical CDC IT infrastructure and provide application and user support services, including service desk, cybersecurity, and infrastructure emergency preparedness.
- **Multi-year service desk incumbency.** Per GAO decisions, NTT has held prior CDC task orders spanning roughly six years across two previous task orders covering on-site application hosting and related services. Consistently described as the incumbent for general IT support in CDC OCIO.
- **2025 ~\$111M task order: returned to NTT after protest.** The task order was first awarded to DMI in early 2025; NTT protested, and the award was ultimately returned to NTT, in part on a SAM.gov / entity-name technicality and on evaluation grounds.

Implications for our capture

- Deepest institutional knowledge at CDC OCIO of any expected competitor
- Demonstrated willingness and capability to protest, which is a major reason CITS is operating under tight protest defensibility
- Embedded delivery workforce we may want to access via teaming partner or staffing intermediaries rather than direct outreach

Sources: NTT DATA press release (Sept 30, 2019); NTT DATA CIMS program page (us.nttdata.com); GAO B-421708.3 / B-421708.4; Washington Technology (Mar 2025, Nov 2023).

RECENT CHALLENGER

Digital Management, Inc. (DMI)

Posture: Federal IT services firm (Bethesda, MD) with prior CDC OCIO task order wins. *Not the current incumbent.* Won a task order in 2025 that was subsequently protested by NTT and returned to NTT.

Important framing on DMI: DMI won the most recent ~\$111M CDC task order in early 2025, but NTT protested on a SAM.gov registration / entity-name technicality (Digital Management Inc. vs. Digital Management LLC) and on evaluation grounds. The award was ultimately returned to NTT. DMI is a recent challenger and a likely bidder, but is not the incumbent.

Public-domain facts to know

- **2025 ~\$111M task order win, then loss after NTT protest.** Awarded to DMI on CDC general IT support; NTT protested; award returned to NTT. The technicality at issue was the SAM.gov entity name (Digital Management Inc. vs. Digital Management LLC) along with evaluation challenges.
- **2023 ~\$27M task order, on-site application hosting at CDC Atlanta data centers.** DMI has been a successful CDC OCIO bidder previously and has CDC-specific past performance.
- **Profile:** Federal IT services firm with health, defense, and civilian portfolio. Demonstrated CDC OCIO familiarity and competitive pricing posture.

Implications for our capture

- Likely to compete aggressively on price given recent loss and history of CDC bids
- Has CDC-specific past performance to draw on
- Their entity-name technicality experience may sharpen their compliance discipline this round

Sources: Washington Technology "NTT Data contests \$111M CDC contract on technicality" (Mar 2025) and "NTT Data loses shot at CDC data center support award" (Nov 2023); FPDS / USASpending records.

Why this protest history matters

Every capture action on CITS is run through a "would this survive a protest challenge" defensibility test. The 2023 and 2025 protest cycles are the main reason the current CITS capture operates under constrained client engagement and tight compliance discipline. Both expected competitors are sophisticated protesters, and the Government's evaluation team is expected to be highly attuned to procedural integrity.

Win Themes & POV

Point of view

POV

"Keep what works, deflect demand, modernize capabilities."

- Maintain ITIL-aligned ServiceNow model
- Expand Level 0 deflection through ServiceNow virtual agent and knowledge-based self-service; expand ServiceNow-native automation; shift eligible Level 1 work to lower-cost U.S. delivery centers
- Estimated savings referenced in earlier capture materials: approximately \$7.1M per year (estimates only). Five-year savings figure referenced previously should be re-baselined against the new 4-year period of performance.

Executive win themes

Fresh leadership without delivery disruption Bring new leadership energy and fresh perspective while protecting operational continuity for CDC customers.
Operational stability first, modernization where it delivers value Protect day-to-day service quality before pursuing modernization, and sequence modernization so it delivers measurable value to CDC users.
Embedded CIO engagement Operate as an embedded partner to the CDC CIO organization, aligning capture and delivery to OCIO priorities.
Flexibility amid HHS uncertainty Build contractual and operational flexibility to absorb HHS-level policy, budget, and organizational change without disrupting CDC customers.
Continuity of trusted talent Retain and redeploy trusted incumbent and partner talent to preserve institutional knowledge and customer trust.
ServiceNow-native automation that compounds efficiencies Year-over-year automation gains delivered through ServiceNow workflow, virtual agent (chatbot), knowledge-based deflection, RPA, and analytics, plus any AI capabilities CDC explicitly provides and approves. The RFQ prohibits us from describing AI products in our technical approach and from using unapproved AI products in performance, so our solution narrative is anchored in proven ServiceNow-native automation rather than vendor-introduced AI.
Streamlined processes and delivery-center-based teams Streamline processes and consolidate eligible work into lower-cost U.S. delivery centers to cut costs, improve consistency, and unlock additional efficiencies across Level 1 and eligible Level 2 work.
Human-Centered Design (HCD) embedded across the approach HCD is embedded across the proposal, not bolted on. CDC's Customer Experience Office leadership makes HCD a real differentiator, especially given the elevation of Mary Peck's role. Partners have reacted strongly to leaning into HCD "at the nth degree."

Teaming Partners

Two teaming partners are active in the current CITS capture, each with a distinct role: a primary teaming partner and a staffing partner.

PRIMARY TEAMING PARTNER

Dynanet

- Task-by-task workshare alignment underway
- Strengths: ServiceNow backend integration, M365, Power Platform, cloud services, zero-trust security
- Maria Thompson, former CDC DSO leader, viewed as influential with continuing CDC relationships
- Objective: lock teaming and exclusivity after workshare clarity
- Weekly check-in begins 4/28, 3:00-3:25 PM ET
- Capability-to-scope crosswalk to subtask and optional sub-task level is the immediate near-term priority

STAFFING PARTNER

Insight Global

- Staffing firm partner
- Initial rates provided
- Primary lever for headcount, LCAT mapping, and city coverage
- Approach: anchor on skills and headcount per subtask, then let Insight Global solve for location
- Likely intermediary for any exploratory NTT-talent outreach (rather than direct outreach), pending leadership alignment
- Working contact: Katie at Insight Global

Scope of Work

The CITS scope per the RFQ is structured into 10 tasks (no Task 7 or Task 12). The structure below mirrors RFQ Section 3.1 Table 1, with required and optional tasks flagged. Descriptions reflect our team's capability framing for each task.

At a glance: 10 tasks · 17 required subtasks · 10 optional subtasks (priced separately in Option Periods) · 27 total subtasks

Note on changes from prior capture deck: Tasks 1.4 (EPS+), 1.5 (ITAMS as standalone), 2.2 (GA+), 3.2 (DARS), 7 (Data Transport / DEX), 11.2, and 12 (Continuous Improvement) were in earlier capability-mapping working drafts but are not in the released RFQ. ITAMS and DARS-style content is now folded into other tasks (e.g., property management referenced under deskside / EP, reporting under Task 10.5). Review the RFQ PWS directly for authoritative scope.

Task 1 — Customer Support Services

3 subtasks (all required)

1.1CDC IT ServiceDesk Services(ITSDS) Required

Multi-channel L1 service desk on ServiceNow + NICE VCC, leveraging CDC knowledge base; ITSM workflow with knowledge-based deflection and ServiceNow virtual agent self-service. Includes hardware repair function (Junior/Journeyman computer hardware engineers and document management specialists per the historical LoE).

1.2Deskside Support Services(DSS) Required

L2 deskside / AV support across CDC images, on-site; endpoint lifecycle via MECM and Intune; zero-touch provisioning and refresh automation. Property management duties cross-referenced to CDC Property Management procedures.

1.3Emergency Preparedness Services and Field Site Services(EPS / FSS) Required

L2/L3 EP and field-site support 24x7 (~400 tickets/month) tracked in ServiceNow against ORR/DEO SLA; on-call rotation; EOC shift coverage; field and exercise support. Field staff perform Property Custodial Officer (PCO) duties at FSS locations. Non-global travel up to \$12K (Base period).

Task 2 — Global Customer Support Services

1 subtask

2.1Global Activities Services(GA) Required

OCONUS network and endpoint support across SD-WAN, VPN, Azure, and MECM; secure global topology with regional automation; international travel readiness (passports, visas, low- and high-threat country travel). Global travel cost-reimbursable up to \$198K (Base period). Engineering and technical support staff require active Cisco Certified Network Associate certification.

Task 3 — IT Management, Analysis & Reporting

1 subtask

3.1Program Management Services(PMS) Required

PMO and governance across QASP, KPIs, weekly status reports, and contract artifacts; risk and financial management; performance dashboards. Program Manager and alternate(s) named as primary technical and managerial interface to CO and COR. Post-award kickoff within 5 business days of award. Monthly leadership reporting to OCIO.

Task 4 — Specialized Support Services

2 subtasks (all optional)

4.1Special IT Projects Services(SITPS) Optional

Rapid surge staffing on 30-day notice for public health emergencies, unknown federal mandates, technology refresh, or building moves; cross-task workload absorption. Activated via contract modification when triggered.

4.2Project Manager & Technical Writer Services(PTS) Optional

Cross-skilled PM and technical writers operating to MS365, EPLC, and OCIO PM standards; full PM lifecycle, executive briefings, 508-compliant documentation. PMs require industry-recognized certification, 4+ years federal experience, Agile delivery experience (2-4 week sprints).

Task 5 — DSO Operations Support Services

3 subtasks (1 required, 2 optional)

5.1IT Project Management Services(ITPM) Required

Enterprise PM across MS Project / Visio, EPLC stage-gate compliance, and DSO PMT (cloud, NAC, M365); technical writing per Subtask 5.1.2. Includes optional expansion via 5.2 / 5.3.

5.2Data Analysis and Reporting Services(D&A) Optional

FAIR data analytics across SQL, PowerBI, and network management tools; performance metrics; quarterly and annual IT reporting. RFQ frames as potential future expansion of DSO Operations services.

5.3IT Communications Services(ITC, DSO) Optional

Communications and marketing across CDC Connects and OCIO web to 508 standards; web content (HTML/JS/XML); backup webmaster; outage protocol. Section-508 compliance required on all deliverables.

Task 6 — Business Automation Support Services

1 subtask

6.1Application Web Development Services(AWD) Required

Web and database app development on ServiceNow App Engine and .NET supporting OCIO Tools; low-code architecture with reusable components.

Task 8 — Identity & Access Management Support Services

3 subtasks (all required)

8.1End Point Management Services(EPM) Required

Patch and config management across MECM, Intune, WSUS, BigFix, and Defender; secure baselines; drift detection and patch automation.

8.2Remote Access Services(RAS) Required

Zero Trust architecture across Azure, Zscaler, MFA, and VDI; policy-based access enabling remote productivity at scale.

8.3Directory Services(DS) Required

Identity lifecycle and brokering across AD, FIM, SQL, and PowerShell; IAM integration patterns; identity automation.

Task 9 — Infrastructure Support Services

7 subtasks (1 required, 6 optional)

9.1Networking Support Services(Net) Required

L2/L3 network support across domestic locations integrated with ITSM tooling; predictive monitoring; hybrid/cloud network design. Non-global travel up to \$15K (Base period).

9.2Data Center Technician Services(DC) Optional

Cabinet and cabling install across on-prem facilities, integrated with CMDB and ITSM; change management; firmware and patching; on-site break-fix.

9.3Virtual Engineer Services (VMware, Other)(VSE) Optional

Hypervisor administration on VMware vSphere/ESX and other hypervisors; storage capacity management; virtualization performance and security.

9.4Operations Services(Ops) Optional

24x7 NOC and Tier-II app support for on-prem private cloud, MOC, ENL; event management; AAR / RCA; runbook authorship.

9.5Data Backup Engineer Services(Bkp) Optional

Backup and restore management on backup infrastructure and FIPS-compliant media; quarterly audits; encryption and key escrow; DR test restores.

9.6 Software Installation Support Services^(SwInst) **Optional**

VM provisioning from golden images aligned to NIST 800-53 baselines; CIA / CCA tooling; SAS Grid / LSF support; FISMA-aligned config.

9.7 Application Hosting and Customer Interface Support Services^(AppHost) **Optional**

QA team services on ServiceNow CM following ITIL processes; ITIL change and config management; CMDB ownership.

Task 10 — Workplace Productivity Support Services

5 subtasks (all required)

10.1 General Requirements (cross-cutting)^(Gen) **Required**

Patch and antivirus management across the M365 platform with CSPO and ENL coordination; APIs and GPOs; SA&A; 24x7 break-fix; vendor case management.

10.2 Communication Email/Messaging Services^(Email) **Required**

Enterprise email and messaging admin across Outlook, Stream, and Intune; HA design; cloud and on-prem operations.

10.3 Enterprise Collaboration Services^(Collab) **Required**

Site collection administration across Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive, and Azure; M365 cloud and on-prem operations.

10.4 Process Automation and Visualization Services^(PA&V) **Required**

Low-code dev and admin across Dynamics 365, Power Platform, and Azure DevOps; workflow automation; PowerBI visualization; data modeling.

10.5 Reporting Services^(Rpt) **Required**

Reporting infrastructure and dashboards on ServiceNow with event data; real-time alerts; integration with performance systems.

Task 11 — OCIO Communications Support Services

1 subtask

11.1 IT Communications Services^(ITC, OCIO) **Required**

OCIO communications and marketing across CDC Connects and OCIO web (508-compliant); stakeholder messaging; web content and multimedia.